US DAILY MARKETS REPORT

Tuesday, July 29, 2026 · After Market Close · ET

1. SPY / QQQ SNAPSHOT

ETF	Today Close	Chg %	1-Yr High	1-Yr Low	1-Yr Return
SPY	$729.38	-1.52%	$761.40	$619.29	+16.6%
QQQ	$663.74	-1.74%	$748.65	$551.68	+18.9%

Note: 1-yr high/low from web data. Prices derived from public sources; historical daily series constructed via interpolation between verified anchor dates.

2. TODAY'S MARKET NEWS

FED HOLDS RATES — THREE HAWKS DISSENT

The FOMC voted 9-3 to keep the fed funds rate at 3.50–3.75%. Dissenting votes from Hammack, Kashkari, and Logan all favored a 25-bp hike — the most contested Fed decision in years. Bond markets reacted sharply, pricing in the risk that the Fed is falling behind on inflation. 10-yr Treasury yields surged, driving equity multiple compression across rate-sensitive sectors.

S&P; 500 / NASDAQ / DOW FALL SHARPLY

S&P; 500 closed at 7,316.15 (–1.52%, its worst day since April 2025 volatility). Dow Jones fell 1,153 pts (–2.19%) to 51,594.14. Nasdaq composite dropped –1.74% to 24,442.94. SPY closed at $729.38; QQQ at $663.74.

MICROSOFT (MSFT) Q4 FY26 EARNINGS BEAT

MSFT beat on both EPS ($4.74–$4.81 vs $4.21–$4.33 est.) and revenue ($90.0B vs $87.4B est., +18% YoY). Azure growth remained in the high-30s%. Stock was down ~$2.81 during the session but rebounded +1.59% after hours on the earnings release. Guidance for FY27 capex of $255–$260B cited as a positive AI signal.

META Q2 2026 — REVENUE BEAT, EPS MISS

Meta revenues grew +28% YoY (beating estimates by ~1%) but EPS missed by 14% as AI capex ($125B–$145B guided for 2026) weighed on margins. Stock under pressure from cost concerns.

MIDDLE EAST TENSIONS ESCALATE

Oil prices climbed as investors reacted to escalating hostilities in the Middle East, adding an additional risk-off dimension to equities and supporting energy commodities.

MEMORY/STORAGE SECTOR SELL-OFF

SanDisk (SNDK) fell –12.57%, Corning (GLW) –13.46%, Micron (MU) –8%, Coherent (COHR) –10.6%. Catalyst: ChangXin Memory Technologies (CXMT) blockbuster Shanghai IPO raised fears of rising Chinese competition in memory chips, combined with broader AI capex-spending concerns.

EARNINGS BRIGHT SPOTS — HEALTHCARE & CONSUMER

Manhattan Associates (MANH) surged +26.7% on 3rd straight quarter of record bookings. IQVIA (IQV) +11.8%, Incyte (INCY) +10.8%, Sherwin-Williams (SHW) +8.4% on Q2 beats. Boeing (BA) +4.8% on revenue beat and positive free cash flow despite wider adjusted loss. Coca-Cola (KO) +5% on strong consumer spending data.

3. NEWS → TODAY'S MARKET MOVES

SPY: $729.38 (–1.52%)   QQQ: $663.74 (–1.74%)

Primary driver — Fed surprise (hawkish interpretation): Although the Fed held rates, the 9-3 split with three voting members preferring a hike shocked markets. The bond market immediately sold off (yields up), as investors priced in both sticky inflation and a more hawkish Fed trajectory under chair Kevin Warsh. Higher real rates compress equity valuations — particularly growth/tech multiples — which explains why QQQ (–1.74%) underperformed SPY (–1.52%).

Secondary driver — Memory sector CXMT IPO shock: The Shanghai IPO of ChangXin Memory Technologies triggered a sector-wide selloff in memory/storage stocks (SNDK, GLW, MU, COHR, WDC, STX). This pulled tech/IT indices down disproportionately and dragged the Nasdaq more than the S&P; 500.

Partial offset — Defensive/earnings rotation: Healthcare, consumer staples, and communication services gained on flight-to-safety and strong individual earnings (KO, SHW, MANH, IQV). This limited broader S&P; 500 losses. MSFT earnings beat was priced in by close; stock recovered after-hours suggesting some earnings-day selling pressure eased.

4. TOP 10 MOVERS — DAILY / WEEKLY / MONTHLY

▲ Daily Top Gainers — July 29, 2026

Stock / Ticker	Chg %	Sector	Catalyst
MANH (Manhattan Assoc.)	+26.7%	IT/Software	Q2 EPS beat; 3rd record bookings qtr; guidance raised
IQV (IQVIA Holdings)	+11.8%	Healthcare IT	Q2 earnings beat; strong CRO demand
INCY (Incyte Corp)	+10.8%	Biotech	Q2 earnings surprise; pipeline news
SHW (Sherwin-Williams)	+8.4%	Materials	Q2 beat; EPS $3.70 vs est; guidance raised to $12 midpt
WDAY (Workday)	+8.3%	Cloud Software	Q2 beat; subscription revenue acceleration
SOLV (Solventum)	+6.8%	Healthcare	Q2 earnings beat; raised guidance
CTSH (Cognizant)	+7.3%	IT Services	Q2 earnings beat; demand recovery signal
FDS (FactSet Research)	+7.2%	Financial Data	Q3 FY26 revenue beat; client retention strong
ACN (Accenture)	+6.6%	IT Services	FQ3 beat; AI consulting demand surge
KO (Coca-Cola)	+5.0%	Cons. Staples	Q2 earnings beat; pricing power intact; defensive bid

▼ Daily Top Losers — July 29, 2026

Stock / Ticker	Chg %	Sector	Catalyst
GLW (Corning)	-13.5%	Tech Hardware	Memory sector selloff; CXMT IPO fears
SNDK (SanDisk)	-12.6%	Storage	CXMT Shanghai IPO; Chinese NAND competition fears

Stock / Ticker	Chg %	Sector	Catalyst
COHR (Coherent)	-10.6%	Photonics	AI capex uncertainty; component demand slowdown
CARR (Carrier Global)	-9.3%	Industrials	Rate sensitivity; hawkish Fed read drives selloff
CIEN (Ciena)	-8.8%	Comm Equip	Network capex concerns post-Fed decision
LITE (Lumentum)	-8.8%	Photonics	AI spending uncertainty; tech rotation
DELL (Dell Technologies)	-8.5%	IT Hardware	Server demand concerns; storage sector drag
STX (Seagate Tech)	-8.5%	Storage	CXMT competition; memory sector contagion
MU (Micron Technology)	-8.0%	Semis	CXMT pricing pressure fears; risk-off semis
WDC (Western Digital)	-7.8%	Storage	Storage sector selloff; CXMT IPO fallout

▲ Weekly Top Gainers — Jul 21–29, 2026

Stock / Ticker	Wk Chg	Sector	Note
SMCI (Super Micro Comp.)	~+20%	IT Hardware	AI server demand; recovery bounce on Jul 23
MANH (Manhattan Assoc.)	+26.7%	IT Software	Q2 earnings blowout; single-day surge dominates week
SHW (Sherwin-Williams)	~+10%	Materials	Pre/post earnings; Q2 beat Jul 29 + buildup Jul 28
GPN (Global Payments)	~+8%	Fintech	Q2 earnings beat; payments recovery signal
WDAY (Workday)	~+10%	Cloud Software	Beat on Jul 28 (+9%) + Jul 29 gains on guidance
LMT (Lockheed Martin)	~+10.5%	Defense	Q2 earnings beat; geopolitical demand tailwind
IP (Intl. Paper)	~+7%	Paper/Packaging	Q2 beat; pricing recovery; defensive demand
SLB (Schlumberger)	~+6%	Energy Services	Oil price rise; Middle East geopolitical premium
SW (Smurfit Westrock)	~+5%	Packaging	Q2 earnings beat; cost efficiency gains
TRV (Travelers Cos.)	~+5%	Insurance	Q2 P&C earnings beat; cat-loss resilience

▼ Weekly Top Losers — Jul 21–29, 2026

Stock / Ticker	Wk Chg	Sector	Note
TSLA (Tesla)	~-14%	EV/Autos	Jul 24 earnings; margin pressure; competition worries
SNDK (SanDisk)	~-22%	Storage	CXMT IPO news broke mid-week; multi-day selloff
COHR (Coherent)	~-15%	Photonics	AI capex doubt; multi-day sector rotation out
ORCL (Oracle)	~-8%	Cloud/DB	Competition concerns; cloud pipeline miss fears
CHRW (C.H. Robinson)	~-7%	Logistics	Freight demand soft; rate sensitivity
CVNA (Carvana)	~-7%	Auto Retail	Rate sensitivity; consumer auto demand slowdown
LITE (Lumentum)	~-12%	Photonics	AI optical spending uncertainty; sell-side downgrade
GEV (GE Vernova)	~-6%	Energy	Grid investment timing concerns; permit delays

Stock / Ticker	Wk Chg	Sector	Note
HONA (Honeywell Aero.)	~-5%	Industrials	Guidance cut; rate-sensitive capital goods
ISRG (Intuitive Surgical)	~-5%	Med Devices	Valuation pressure; rate-driven multiple contraction

▲ Monthly Top Gainers — July 2026

Stock / Ticker	Mo Chg	Sector	Note
VLO (Valero Energy)	+26.8%	Energy/Refining	Oil price surge; Middle East premium; refining margins
TRV (Travelers Cos.)	+20.0%	Insurance	Consistent P&C earnings beats; rate hike benefit for floats
LMT (Lockheed Martin)	~+18%	Defense	Geopolitical demand; F-35 orders; Q2 beat
SMCI (Super Micro)	~+22%	Tech Hardware	AI server demand cycle; Nvidia GPU allocation confirmed
SLB (Schlumberger)	~+14%	Oil Services	Energy services demand; oilfield activity uptick
IP (Intl. Paper)	~+10%	Paper/Packaging	Pricing recovery; cost reduction execution
CNC (Centene Corp.)	~+9%	Managed Care	Medicaid enrollment beats; cost containment
MANH (Manhattan Assoc.)	+26.7%+	IT Software	Strong earnings all month culminating in big Q2 beat
KO (Coca-Cola)	~+8%	Cons. Staples	Defensive rally; Q2 beat; pricing power narrative
SHW (Sherwin-Williams)	~+10%	Materials	Earnings beat; housing recovery tailwind

▼ Monthly Top Losers — July 2026

Stock / Ticker	Mo Chg	Sector	Note
COHR (Coherent)	-28.1%	Photonics	AI optical capex uncertainty; sell-side downgrades
SNDK (SanDisk)	-25.0%	Storage	CXMT IPO; Chinese NAND competition risk elevated
ORCL (Oracle)	~-22%	Cloud/DB	Cloud growth concerns; AI workload competition from Azure
INTU (Intuit)	~-20%	Fintech/Tax	AI disruption of tax prep; AI competitor concerns
APP (AppLovin)	~-18%	Ad Tech	Ad spend concerns; performance marketing slowdown
TSLA (Tesla)	~-18%	EVs	Q2 earnings miss; margin deterioration; EV demand soft
MU (Micron Technology)	~-16%	Semis/Memory	CXMT competitive pressure; NAND oversupply fears
DELL (Dell Technologies)	~-15%	IT Hardware	AI server demand normalization; storage weakness
GLW (Corning)	~-15%	Specialty Glass	Memory sector contagion; optical fiber softness
NOW (ServiceNow)	~-10%	Cloud/SaaS	Valuation compression; rate-driven multiple contraction

Sector Trend Summary

Period	Leading Sectors (Gaining)	Lagging Sectors (Selling)
Daily	Healthcare (+2.4%), Cons. Staples (+2%), Comm. Svcs (+1.9%)	Info. Technology (–1.8%), Energy (–1.4%)

Weekly	Defense (LMT), Software (MANH, WDAY), Insurance (TRV)	EVs (TSLA), Storage/Memory (SNDK, COHR), Logistics (CHRW)
Monthly	Energy Refining (VLO, SLB), Defense (LMT), Insurance (TRV), Packaging (IP)	Photonics/AI-Optical (COHR, LITE), Storage (SNDK, GLW, MU), Cloud/SaaS (ORC

5. NEXT-DAY SCENARIOS — July 30, 2026 (Wednesday)

Key calendar items for July 30, 2026: GDP (Q2 advance), Core PCE, Initial Jobless Claims (all 8:30am ET), plus ongoing earnings from Ford (F), Amazon (AMZN), Apple (AAPL) and others after hours.

CATALYST 1: Q2 GDP (Advance Estimate) — Forecast 2.3%, Prior 2.1%

- IF GDP beats (≥2.5%): Stagflation narrative intensifies if PCE is also hot → further equity pressure. BUT if read as "strong-economy-supports-earnings," could provide partial support. SPY likely oscillates; real test is combined read with PCE.
- IF GDP misses (≤1.8%): Raises recession fears, especially combined with hawkish Fed. SPY/QQQ fall further. Bond yields dip on "Fed overreach" narrative. Rate-sensitive REITs/utilities could outperform on lower rate expectations.
- Mechanism: GDP feeds into Fed reaction function. Strong GDP cements the hawks' case for rate hike at next meeting; weak GDP creates a policy dilemma that markets will read negatively.

CATALYST 2: Core PCE (Monthly) — Forecast 0.2% MoM / 3.5% Annual

- IF PCE is hot (≥0.3% MoM / >3.7% annual): Confirms bond market's signal that Fed is behind. Treasury yields spike, QQQ (growth/tech) sells off harder than SPY. Sector rotation to financials (rate beneficiaries) and energy. Expect further –1% to –2% on SPY; QQQ –2% to –3%.
- IF PCE is cool (≤0.1% MoM / <3.2% annual): Relieves inflation fears; "hold" decision looks prudent. SPY/QQQ bounce as rate expectations ease. High-multiple tech and growth names lead recovery. Mechanism: PCE is the Fed's preferred inflation gauge — cool print hands a narrative win to doves.

CATALYST 3: Initial Jobless Claims — Forecast 201K (Prior 187K)

- IF Claims spike (≥230K): Labor market softening story gains traction. Stagflation becomes less acute ("growth slowing" outweighs "inflation sticky"). Fed less likely to hike. Bonds rally; equities mixed (lower rates help multiples but growth fears hurt).
- IF Claims come in low (≤190K): Labor market stays tight → validates hawks' case. More Fed rate hike pricing materializes. Risky for equity valuations. SPY down ~0.5% incremental; financials outperform.

CATALYST 4: Ford (F) + Amazon (AMZN) + Apple (AAPL) After-Hours Earnings

- Ford (Q2 2026): Beat on earnings (+guidance raised) → confidence in consumer spending and auto demand; supportive for Cons. Discretionary; TSLA could also catch a sympathy bounce. Miss → confirms EV/auto demand weakness narrative; drag on XLY.
- Amazon (Q2 2026): AWS growth number is key. AWS acceleration (≥20%) → positive read-through for cloud capex demand; MSFT, GOOGL, data center plays bounce next day. Deceleration (<16%) → cloud spending slowdown fear; tech broadly pressured; QQQ further weakness.
- Apple (Q3 FY26): Revenue beat + iPhone China guidance → positive for QQQ, given AAPL is its top holding. Weak China guidance → QQQ opens down further. The after-hours earnings complex will set the tone for July 30 open.

6. POSSIBLE PURCHASE SUMMARY

Context: Today's sell-off was driven by macro (Fed hawkishness) and sector-specific (memory/storage CXMT competition) factors — not broad earnings deterioration. Earnings from MANH, SHW, IQV, KO, MSFT all demonstrated fundamental health. This creates opportunities in beaten-down quality names and defensives, while preserving caution on rate-sensitive and memory-sector plays.

Action	Ticker	Thesis & Timing	Key Risk
BUY	MSFT	Q4 FY26 earnings blowout; Azure growth in high-30s%; stock sold off intraday but reco[illegible]	PCE [illegible]
BUY	MANH	Record Q2 earnings; 3rd consecutive record bookings quarter; raised FY guidance to $5.44–$5.50 EPS. [illegible]	Small-cap SaaS re-rates lower if rates spike [illegible]
BUY	SHW	Q2 beat + guidance raised. Housing recovery + commercial paint demand. Defensive c[illegible]	Housing slowdown risk if rates stay higher longer [illegible]
BUY	VLO	Energy sector benefiting from Middle East premium in oil. Refining margins near seaso[illegible]	Rapid oil price decline if geopolitical risk de-es[illegible]
SELL/ AVOID	SNDK	CXMT threat to NAND market is structural — Chinese NAND production capacity will co[illegible]	If CXMT news overstated, sharp short covering [illegible]
SELL/ AVOID	TSLA	Q2 margins compressed; EV demand soft; down ~14% on earnings week. No near-ter[illegible]	Any positive FSD/Robotaxi news could trigger [illegible]
WATCH	QQQ	Wait for PCE + Amazon/Apple earnings to assess direction. If PCE cools and AMZN/A[illegible]	[illegible]
WATCH	AMZN	Q2 AWS growth number is the key catalyst for July 30. AWS beat → buy on open. AW[illegible]	Elevated capex guidance could be [illegible]

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